18.14 Electroconvulsive Therapy (ECT)*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "Will the electricity hurt my brain?" **Objective** • First ECT session booked • Restless	**ACTUAL** Excessive anxiety related to the ECT procedure as evidenced by fear and questioning.	• Less anxious before treatment.	• Explain the procedure, the anesthetic and the expected effects. • Answer questions honestly. • Make sure consent is obtained as law and policy require.	• Outcome reached when she is calmer.
Subjective • "Will I lose my memory?" **Objective** • Asks about side effects • Cannot describe how to prepare	**ACTUAL** Inadequate health knowledge related to ECT preparation and adverse effects as evidenced by questioning.	• Describes the preparation and the expected effects.	• Teach fasting and removal of dentures and jewelry. • Explain that short-term memory loss and headache may occur.	• Considered met when she describes them.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • General anesthetic • Confused after treatment	**RISK** Risk for acute confusion as evidenced by risk factors: anesthesia and induced seizure.	• Oriented after recovery from each treatment.	• Watch vital signs and airway after treatment. • Reorient her. • Stay until she is fully alert.	• Goal reached once she is oriented.

*References for this care plan: [31], [35], [97]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.